The everyday habits silently wearing down your spine—from screen slouching to weak cores—and why back pain now strikes decades earlier

WHAT CONDITIONS ARE EMERGING EARLY

CERVICAL SPONDYLOSIS (NECK ARTHRITIS)

BEFORE: Usually after 50 due to age-related wear

NOW: Early 20s–30s from prolonged tech neck, poor ergonomics and weak neck muscles

EARLY-AGE TRIGGER: Continuous forward head posture from devices, no neck-strengthening exercises

OSTEOPOROTIC VERTEBRAL FRACTURES

BEFORE: Common in post-menopausal women or elderly men

NOW: Showing up in under-30 adults

EARLY-AGE TRIGGER: Severe Vitamin D deficiency, eating disorders and extreme diets



SPINAL STENOSIS (NARROWED SPINAL CANAL)

BEFORE: Age-related bone overgrowth and ligament thickening

NOW: Early degeneration in 20s–30s

EARLY-AGE TRIGGER: Weight training without form supervision, repetitive strain and sports injuries

FACET JOINT ARTHRITIS

BEFORE: Age-linked cartilage wear in the joints between vertebrae

NOW: Appearing in overweight young adults

EARLY-AGE TRIGGER: Obesity, repeated heavy lifting and high-impact workouts without spine conditioning

LUMBAR DISC DEGENERATION

BEFORE: Gradual disc dehydration and thinning in 40s–50s

NOW: Seen in young desk workers and gamers

EARLY-AGE TRIGGER: Sedentary lifestyle, obesity and prolonged sitting without breaks